



Radeon R9 285 launch date

According to reports, AMD will launch the Tonga based Radeon R9 285 this month which will compete with Nvidia's GK104. <http://dgit.in/Tonga285>



G.Skill DDR4 announced

With Intel's X99 just around the corner, DDR4 memory kits are incoming. Including Ripjaws! <http://dgit.in/GSkillDDR4>

Bazaar

LG G3

The best that Android has to offer. That is all.

LG has been making a pretty legitimate claim on the smartphone market for some time now, but the company doesn't quite have the numbers to show for it. With its newest flagship, the company is launching a fresh assault.

The LG G3 has arguably the best design amongst the flagship high-priced smartphones today. It has a 5.5 inch display and is 8.9 mm thick with a plastic body with a brushed metallic finish. LG has devised a special film, which takes away the plasticky feel from the device and combined with the brushed finish, gives the phone very good look and feel value.

Moreover, what is really good about the G3's build though is how easily it fits in your hand. LG has done this by doing two things — one by giving the phone very slim bezels and two by giving it the curved back. While the former makes the phone as big as some 5-inch smartphones, the latter makes it fit right into your hand.

While the G3 doesn't quite suit single-handed usage, it does so much better than many other devices that have a smaller screen. It also feels very sturdy and once you get used to the rear buttons on the G3, you wouldn't want to have it any other way.

One of the differentiating features of the G3 is that it has a quad-HD screen. This is one of only two smartphones in India to sport a quad-HD display (the other one being the Oppo Find 7). The display is good, but to the naked eye, the quad-HD isn't that different from a full-HD, making this more of a gimmick for the consumer.

The G3's display is actually a little disappointing because of how sensitive it is to fingerprints. While this is a very bright screen, the fingerprint intensiveness really affects the sunlight visibility of the smartphone. There are plenty of devices in this segment that provide better sunlight visibility and it is something you would definitely want if you spend over ₹40,000 on your phone. It's a vibrant and bright display when you're indoors



Price
₹46,899

though. You would enjoy playing games and watching videos on it.

On the UI front, while LG has made a lot of changes, it has a simplistic UI compared to many others. This makes the UI easy to learn and use, while also adding something new to how the phone feels.

As flagships go, the G3 provides uncompromised performance with the 2.5 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 801 quad core SoC and the Adreno 330 GPU. The performance is fluid, with no lags in the UI or while playing high-end games like Dead Trigger 2, Asphalt 8 and Injustice: Gods Among Us. The phone does heat up quite a bit, but also takes very less time to cool down. Also, it doesn't heat up enough to feel uncomfortable, which is very good. Overall, no complaints with the G3's performance.

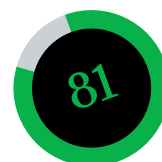
The quad-HD display isn't the only new feature on the G3. One of its biggest strengths is in the 13 MP rear camera, which has a laser auto-focus system. The G3's camera is definitely one of the best that you can find today. We tested it against an iPhone 5S and found that the camera comes very close to the 5S in terms of white balance and overall picture quality. The G3 also surpasses the iPhone in low-light imaging. This we also tested against an Xperia Z1 Compact and the G3 did better than the Z1 Compact.

The camera UI also takes a cue from LG's overall UI and is very simplistic and fast. Considering the overall camera experience, the G3 could very well be the best camera that you can find on a smartphone right now.

Conclusion

The LG G3 has the best design amongst flagships right now and is possibly the best in that range as well. The phone provides a very good overall experience and leaves little room for complaint. If you have the budget for a flagship smartphone then this would definitely be our first recommendation.

Prasid Banerjee



Features 80
Performance 80
Build & Design 90
Value for money 75

Specifications

Screen: 5.5-inch, 2560x1440 res, IPS panel; **SoC:** Qualcomm Snapdragon 801 quad-core 2.5GHz; **RAM:** 2GB; **Storage:** 16GB; **GPU:** Adreno 330; **Camera:** 13MP (rear), 2.1MP (front); **Weight:** 151g

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